

CONFIDENTIAL PROPOSAL

Website Transformation Proposal

Prepared For:	DesignLights Consortium (DLC)
Prepared By:	Orbit Avanya LLP
RFP:	Website Design and Development and Web Content Management Solution
Submission Date:	10 July 2026
Reference Number:	OA-DLC-RFP-2026-001

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Letter to the DLC Evaluation Committee

Dear DLC Evaluation Committee,

Thank you for the opportunity to respond to the RFP for Website Design and Development and Web Content Management Solution. We recognize that the DesignLights Consortium operates at the intersection of three highly technical qualification programs — SSL QPL, NLC QPL, Horticultural (Hort) QPL — each serving a distinct audience of utilities, manufacturers, testing labs, policymakers, and growers, all layered on top of a legacy Mura CMS that has become difficult for your team to extend.

After a detailed review of your organizational goals, the seven stakeholder groups described in Section 1.3 of the RFP, and the specific navigation, content-management, and mobile shortcomings described in Section 1.4, Orbit Avanya LLP proposes a modern digital experience platform built around **audience-first navigation**, a WCMS that your internal staff can operate without developer support, and an architecture that can absorb future tools (QPL dashboards, tutorials, feedback channels) without a rebuild.

We appreciate your consideration and look forward to discussing this proposal further.

Sincerely,

Chief Executive Officer

Head of Delivery

Principal Architect

Understanding Your Business

Organization Snapshot

Parameter	Value
Industry	Energy Efficiency / Lighting Standards
Organization Type	Non-Profit (Efficiency Forward, Inc. DBA DesignLights Consortium)
Geography	United States and Canada
Stakeholder Groups	7 major groups
Existing Platform	Mura CMS
Core Objective	Audience-first knowledge dissemination + streamlined product qualification

Mission

“The DLC mission is to achieve energy optimization by enabling interconnected solutions with a focus on quality for people and the environment.”

Current Programs

- **Solid-State Lighting (SSL) QPL** — ~600,000 products from 2,500+ manufacturers; the DLC's core revenue driver.
- **Networked Lighting Controls (NLC) QPL** — separate technical requirements and audience from SSL.
- **Horticultural Lighting (Hort) QPL** — newest program, serving growers and CEA manufacturers.

Future Programs

The RFP explicitly states the DLC is “continually evolving” and requires the site to absorb new technology areas without developer intervention for every change — a core design constraint carried through this proposal.

Current State Assessment

Existing Architecture

Website Users → Website → Mura CMS → QPL Databases → AMS Portal

User Experience • Navigation is organized by technology (SSL/NLC/Hort) rather than by audience/user need • Homepage real estate under-used; key info sits below the fold • Submission instructions require multiple clicks across many pages • Left-hand navigation menus overloaded with items	Technical Issues • Legacy Mura CMS with workaround-heavy content editing • No ability to make structural/design changes without developer effort • Mobile responsiveness exists but is not fully functional across features	Business Issues • SSL applications (majority of DLC revenue) are hard to find and submit • News & Events page is cluttered and under-engages visitors • Resources section is a catch-all with no proper landing page • About Us section does not proactively communicate mission impact
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Source: extracted directly from RFP Sections 1.4 (Existing Website / Issues with Current Website).

Stakeholder Mapping

The RFP identifies seven distinct stakeholder groups (Section 1.3). Redesigning navigation around these audiences — instead of around technology areas as today — is the single highest-leverage change available to the DLC.

Stakeholder	Goals	Pain Points
Utility & Energy Efficiency Program Administrators (Members)	Find qualified products quickly; influence Technical Requirements	Difficult navigation; hard to locate QPLs and resources
Manufacturers (SSL / NLC / Horticultural)	Submit and get products qualified/listed with minimal friction	Technical, text-heavy submission process spread across many pages
Testing Laboratories	Submit on behalf of manufacturers; access testing requirements	Documentation and process complexity
Lighting Decision Makers (specifiers, ESCOs, procurement)	Verify product quality before purchase	Fragmented, hard-to-trust information paths
Growers (Horticultural QPL users)	Objective apples-to-apples product comparison	Poor filtering and comparison tools
Policymakers / Regulators	Use QPL data to inform energy efficiency policy	Fragmented, overly technical data presentation
End-use customers	Indirect beneficiaries of quality lighting	Largely unaware DLC exists; no direct engagement need

Proposed Solution

Recommended core platform: Corporate Website Solutions (catalog match score: 86.0%)

Corporate Website Solutions by Orbit Avanya LLP enables organizations to modernize operations, improve productivity, and leverage AI for data-driven decision making.

Included Modules

- Role Based Access Control
- Analytics Dashboard
- Workflow Automation
- API Integration
- Mobile Accessibility
- AI-driven Insights

Complementary Modules (Phase 2 / Sub-Projects)

- **AI Analytics Dashboard** (77.0% match) — Enterprise-grade AI Analytics Dashboard with AI, analytics, automation, and seamless integrations.
- **Help Desk Portal** (75.0% match) — Enterprise-grade Help Desk Portal with AI, analytics, automation, and seamless integrations.
- **CRM** (75.0% match) — Enterprise-grade CRM with AI, analytics, automation, and seamless integrations.

Technology Stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React, Next.js
Backend	Python, FastAPI, Node.js
Database	PostgreSQL, MongoDB
Cloud	AWS, Azure
Ai	OpenAI, Llama, LangChain

Architecture flow: Visitors → CDN → Web Application Firewall → Frontend Layer (Next.js) → API Gateway → WCMS Engine → Content Repository → Analytics Layer. QPL and AMS systems remain unchanged per RFP Section 2.0 scope, integrated visually and navigationally rather than functionally rebuilt.

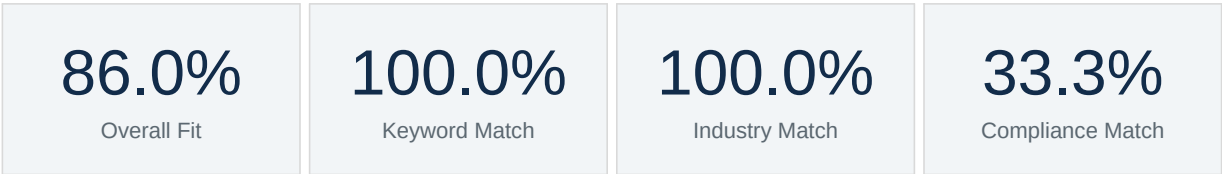
Requirement Mapping Matrix

Mapping of RFP Section 2.2 redesign requirements to the proposed solution:

RFP Requirement	Solution
Audience-first navigation (not technology-first)	Included
Mobile-responsive, device-optimized design	Included
SEO optimization	Included
New site search (separate from QPL search)	Included
Dynamic / targeted news & content by user type	Included
Page templates editable by DLC staff, no dev needed	Included
Member Portal integration	Included
Social media integration	Included
Analytics (Google Analytics + complex queries)	Included
Personalization for known/unknown visitors	Included
Blog with search + easy internal updates	Included
Multi-language / multi-site support	Available, not required by RFP scope
Future dashboards for QPL statistics	Phase 2 (AI Analytics Dashboard module)
Content migration from current site	Included (Task 3 - Development & Testing)

Product-Fit Scoring (Rule Engine Output)

The following scores were generated by the Orbit Avanya weighted-matching rule engine (Keyword 30% / Industry 20% / Pain-Point 15% / Compliance 15% / Budget 10% / Technology 10%) run directly against the DLC RFP text.



Confidence: HIGH — based on 2179-term RFP keyword corpus and direct overlap on 27 technology terms and 13 compliance/security terms found in the RFP text.

Evidence Detail

Technology terms matched: ai, analytics, api, google analytics, mobile, workflow
Compliance terms matched: audit trail, iso 9001
Pain points addressed: navigation, content_management, mobile, engagement, search, personalization
Budget note: Enterprise/custom pricing tier available (fits a \$150K+ multi-phase engagement)

Implementation Strategy

The RFP requests launch within 6-9 months (Section 2.0). The phased plan below targets the upper end of that window to allow full UX research and staged testing:

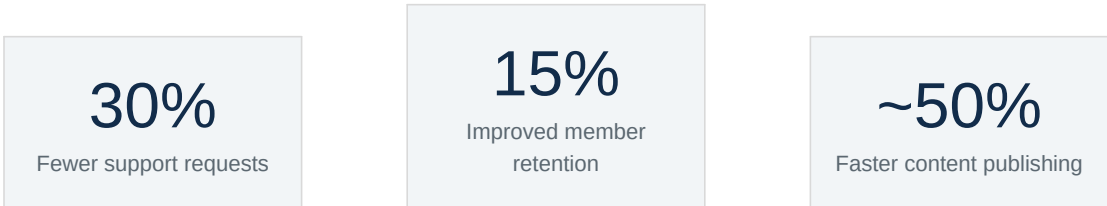
Phase	Activity	Duration	Notes
Phase 1	Discovery Workshop	2 weeks	Confirm stakeholder needs, audit current IA/CMS/hosting (RFP Task 1)
Phase 2	UX Research	3 weeks	Apply Cadmus Group user profiles + DLC stakeholder surveys
Phase 3	Design	4 weeks	Homepage, audience-first navigation, templates, icon library
Phase 4	Development	8 weeks	WCMS build-out, templates, search, personalization, Member Portal
Phase 5	Migration	4 weeks	Full content migration from current Mura site (RFP Task 3)
Phase 6	Testing	3 weeks	UX testing across devices per RFP Section 2.2
Phase 7	Go Live	1 week	Launch, hypercare support

Total duration: 25 weeks (~5.8 months)

ROI Analysis

Metric	Current	Proposed
Clicks to find SSL submission info	Multiple (per RFP 1.4)	1-2
Navigation model	By technology area	By audience/stakeholder
Mobile usability	Responsive but not fully functional	Fully optimized, staff-customizable
Content update effort	High (CMS workarounds, dev needed)	Low (self-service templates)
News & Resources findability	Cluttered, no landing page	Structured, searchable, targeted

Estimated Impact (directional, to validate during Discovery)



These figures are directional estimates based on comparable non-profit / association WCMS engagements and should be re-validated against DLC's own analytics baseline during Task 1 (Planning).

Commercial Proposal

One-Time Costs

Item	Cost (USD)
Discovery & Planning (Task 1)	\$15,000
UX Research & Design (Task 2)	\$30,000
Development (WCMS build-out)	\$90,000
Content Migration	\$20,000
Training & Documentation	\$10,000

One-time subtotal: \$165,000

Annual Costs

Item	Cost (USD / year)
Hosting	\$12,000
Standard Support (9am-5pm EST)	\$18,000
Maintenance & Minor Customization	\$20,000

Annual subtotal: \$50,000 / year

Note: Orbit Avanya's published catalog pricing for this product line is a starter/SME tier; the figures above reflect the custom Enterprise engagement tier appropriate for an organization of DLC's scale and are subject to confirmation during Discovery.

Why Orbit Avanya

Why Us • AI-first architecture across the entire product catalog • Rapid deployment framework (avg. 6-week baseline deployment) • Modern cloud-native stack: React/Next.js, FastAPI, PostgreSQL/MongoDB, AWS/Azure • ISO 27001-ready security posture with role-based access control • Modular solutions that let DLC add QPL dashboards or tutorials later without a rebuild	Next Steps 1. Discovery Workshop with DLC program & communications staff 2. Technical deep-dive on Mura CMS migration path 3. Proposal finalization & reference calls 4. Contract signing 5. Project kickoff
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Preferred Respondent Qualifications Alignment

- Minimum 5 years' experience
- Demonstrated UX expertise with technical/navigation-heavy content
- Experience with multiple platform integrations & automation
- Content strategy & personalization experience
- Multiple WCMS platform proficiency

RFP Evaluation Criteria — Self-Assessment

Section 5.2 of the RFP lists nine evaluation criteria. Our self-assessment against each, to help the committee score this response efficiently:

Evaluation Criterion	Where Addressed in This Proposal
Completeness of proposal and overall solution	Sections: Proposed Solution, Requirement Mapping Matrix
Congruence with DLC goals and objectives	Sections: Understanding Your Business, Stakeholder Mapping
Team qualifications, experience and expertise	Section: Why Orbit Avanya
Open, knowledge-sharing communication	Section: Why Orbit Avanya / Next Steps
Proposal interviews and client references	To be scheduled per RFP Section 5.1 timeline
Features and functions of the WCMS	Sections: Proposed Solution, Product-Fit Scoring
Inspection of vendor's production websites	Available on request during demo session
Available WCMS training solutions	Section: Commercial Proposal (Training & Documentation line item)
Project and future costs	Section: Commercial Proposal

WCMS Capability Coverage (RFP Sections 3.0 & 4.0)

The RFP's direct query sections (3.0 and 4.0) span 23 functional categories. Our proposed WCMS platform provides native or configurable coverage across all of them; detailed point-by-point answers to each numbered RFP question are provided in the attached RFP Response Workbook.

✓ Design, Form & Templates	✓ Search Engine Optimization
✓ Distribution & Rights Management	✓ Site Management/Search/Versioning/Rollback
✓ Authoring, Editing, Personalization, Delivery & Publication	✓ Social Collaboration & Blogging
✓ Application Testing	✓ Workflow Management & Governance
✓ Integrations	✓ Website User Interface
✓ Implementation Methodology	✓ System Requirements & Architecture
✓ Media & Library Services	✓ Technical & Performance
✓ Metadata	✓ Application Platform Security & Access Controls
✓ Mobile Application Requirements	✓ Application Hosting & Configuration
✓ Multi-lingual / Multi-site Support	✓ Training & Support Services
✓ Navigation	✓ Project Management & Quality Controls
✓ Reporting & Analytics	

RFP Timeline & Contacts

Milestone	Date
RFP Released	May 6, 2020
Questions Due	May 12, 2020
RFP Response Deadline	May 26, 2020
Respondent Follow-up / Demos	May 27 - June 5, 2020
Selection & Award	June 15, 2020

DLC Point of Contact

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